

BROKEN THINGS

TEXT: 1 Corinthians 11:23-30 (NKJV)

“For I received from the Lord that which I also delivered to you: that the Lord Jesus on the same night in which He was betrayed took bread; 24 and when He had given thanks, He broke it and said, “Take, eat; this is My body which is broken for you; do this in remembrance of Me.” 25 In the same manner He also took the cup after supper, saying, “This cup is the new covenant in My blood. This do, as often as you drink it, in remembrance of Me.” 26 For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord’s death till He comes. 27 Therefore whoever eats this bread or drinks this cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner will be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord. 28 But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup. 29 For he who eats and drinks in an

unworthy manner eats and drinks judgment to himself, not discerning the Lord's body. 30 For this reason many are weak and sick among you, and many sleep."

INTRO: My mom used to say *"I can't have anything nice with you around."*

Our world discounts the value of broken things therefore, rather than fixing the things that are broken we tend to discard them:

- Resale and thrift stores... It is here that you can purchase things for pennies on the dollar (Susan say's *"I am saving you money"*)
- Landfills... If you see a hill in Houston it is a landfill or an overpass – It is here that valuable things have been discarded, because they have lost their value
- Wrecking yards... Women's parking lot
 - Vehicles that have been wrecked are torn apart, crushed and recycled

The Bible is a book about broken things:

- Broken world... The sin of Adam and Eve introduced brokenness to an unbroken world – Adam broke paradise
- Broken law... Aaron said, “*We threw the gold in and out walked a calf!*” – If we break one part of the law, it is utterly broken
- Broken people... Noah got drunk – Abraham lied – Isaac lied – They just named Jacob liar - David cheated – Peter cussed – Paul said “*I am the chief of sinners...*”
- Broken promises... Promises are made to be broken

Twice in our text Paul uses the word broken to describe the very important ordinance of communion, “*When He had given thanks, He broke it and said, “Take, eat; this is My body which is broken for you; do this in remembrance of Me.”*”

Today, I want to look at three broken things as we partake of the Lords Supper.

I. A BROKEN LIFE...

The only reason we can take communion today is because Jesus allowed His life to be broken:

- He was only 33 years old when He was crucified... That is broken!
- He lived a sinless life, yet He was treated as guilty of the worst of society... That is broken!
- His human relationships would completely change because of his beating and crucifixion... Peter was not the only one to deny Jesus on the day of His crucifixion – Simon carried His cross – The disciples forsook Him and fled – That is broken!

As Jesus broke the bread and distributed it to His disciples, He had in the mind the broken

lives of every man, woman, and child that would ever live.

He could look at all of us, from Adam down through all of His descendants, and His heart was stirred with a desire for reconciliation and restoration.

God's deepest desire is that the broken lives of today become the restored lives of tomorrow. When Jesus sees the brokenness of our souls, He is moved to compassion.

The work of Christ was directed toward the brokenness of the human race. Luke 4:18-19 (NIV) ***"The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to release the oppressed, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor"***

II. A BROKEN BODY...

Those attending the kangaroo court and crucifixion of Jesus had a front row seat to the most horrific breaking of a human body ever to be witnessed by humankind.

- They heard the power of the whip that beat his back to a bloody pulp...
- They heard the “*Thud*” of the cat of nine tails as it found its target in the flesh and muscle in the back of Jesus...
- They could see the bloody sweat as it covered the whipping post...
- They heard the dripping of His blood and see it form a dirty pool on the ground...
- They saw His sinless blood trickle down His naked side and drip off His toes...
- They saw His blood oozing from the spikes in His wrists and ankles...
- They saw blood and water gush into a sacrificial fountain as the spear was thrust into His side...

- They heard the sighs, the groans of the Savior as He submitted to the agony thrust upon Him by the sins of the world...
- They could see the fierce pain and rejection crease His brow as God the Father turned His back because He could not bear to look upon Him. this occurred because of the enormity of the sin laid upon Him...
- They could clearly see the parched lips of a sinless savior, as he begged for a drink of water but was offered vinegar on a sponge... (Talk about this)
- They heard the passion in His voice as He prayed, ***“Forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing.”***

Paul’s Corinthian audience were very much aware to the gravity of His words as he mentioned the breaking of the bread that points to the breaking of His body!

His body was broken FOR US!

Fanny Crosby wrote these timeless words:

“Jesus, keep me near the cross, There a precious fountain - Free to all, a healing stream - Flows from Calv’ry’s mountain.

Refrain:

In the cross, in the cross, Be my glory ever - Till my raptured soul shall find - Rest beyond the river.

Near the cross, a trembling soul, Love and Mercy found me - There the bright and morning star - Sheds its beams around me.

Near the cross! O Lamb of God, Bring its scenes before me - Help me walk from day to day, With its shadows o’er me.

Near the cross I’ll watch and wait, Hoping, trusting ever - Till I reach the golden strand, Just beyond the river.”

The Lord's Supper represents the broken body of Jesus Christ on the Cross. But more than that, it represents the length to which God is willing to go to restore a broken world, and the broken lives of all who dwell there.

III. A BROKEN HEART...

The heart of Jesus was broken for the sins of the world. Two times we are told that Jesus wept:

- Over the city of Jerusalem... Luke 19
“Jerusalem, Jerusalem, how often would I have gathered you under my wings as a hen does her chickens...”
- At the tomb of Lazarus... John 11
(Shortest verse in the Bible – The people said, *“See how He loved him...”*)

The heart of Jesus was no doubt broken as He celebrated the Passover with His disciples knowing that Judas had already

betrayed Him!

We look at how Judas betrayed Jesus and say *“How could he have done such a thing?”*

Allow me to put it into perspective by saying:

- We are all guilty of the sin of Adam...
Intentional sin - breaks the heart of Jesus!
- We are all guilty of the sin of Peter...
We have rejected Him by distancing ourselves from Him! This breaks His heart!
- We are all guilty of the sin of Judas...
We have sold Him for far less than thirty pieces of silver! This breaks His heart!

CONCLUSION:

As I take communion today I do so realizing:

- My foolish actions drove the spikes into

His wrists and ankles...

- My bad attitude thrust the spear into His side...
- My complacency moved Him to the action of the cross...
- My cruelty fueled His compassion...
- My sin brought His grace...